



INDUSTRY NEWS

MAKE IN INDIA

Cabinet gives nod to incentives for electronics

Union Cabinet has approved the amendment in Modified Special Incentive Package Scheme (M-SIPS) to incentivise investments in the electronics sector by cutting down the application window by about one and a half year to December 31, 2018, and capping the outflow at ₹ 100 billion.

The previous amendment in M-SIPS was made in August 2015 and had extended the scheme till July 27, 2020. Law and information technology minister Ravi Shankar Prasad has said, "If the investment is more than of US\$ 1 billion, then a high-powered committee presided by the Cabinet secretary will approve it."

Applications will be received under the scheme up to 31st December 2018 or till such time that an incentive commitment of ₹ 100 billion is reached, whichever is earlier. In case the incentive commitment of ₹ 100 billion is reached, a review will be held to decide further financial commitments.

Electronics clusters to be set up in 400 cities

Electronics and information technology minister Ravi Shankar Prasad said while speaking at Pravasi Haryana Diwas 2017, in Gurugram (Haryana) that, with focus on electronics manufacturing in the country, the government of India has planned to establish electronics clusters in 400 cities and towns across India. He added that, the electronics manufacturing market in India would be around US\$ 400 billion by 2020.

The minister has praised the initiatives taken by Haryana chief minister Manohar Lal Khattar and his government to encourage information technology services in the state. He said that when he took over charge of his ministry, India's exports were ₹ 11 billion, which have now grown to ₹ 126 billion as of end of December 2016. Haryana has a lot of possibilities and potential for innovations in the areas of digital payments, artificial intelligence, the Internet, cyber security and digital education. These can become great platforms for the growth of mid- and small-scale enterprises.

He also said that the number of mobile phones users in India is equivalent to the combined population of Italy and France, and around 42 mobile phone manufacturing firms and 30 component manufacturing units have already been set up in the country.

On The Move

LG Electronics rejigs India leadership

LG Electronics India has rejigged its senior leadership team, as it tries to spruce up the business after a year of dismal growth, and when white goods sales are forecast to remain muted for at least another quarter due to demonetisation. The company has made changes in about 30 key roles at its local headquarters as well as regional and branch levels, apart from deciding to decentralise the marketing function to focus on localised initiatives and consumer promotions.

Amit Gujral, who is head of mobile business marketing, has now been given the additional responsibility of chief marketing officer of the company. The erstwhile chief marketing officer, Niladri Datta, has been moved to a sales role to head the washing machine business.

Rishi Tandon, who was head of Delhi region, has been made the head of home entertainment business to lead sales for LED televisions and home theatres. The earlier head for LED TV business, Anuj Ayyodhyawasi, has been made head for refrigerator business.

Movements at IBM India

IBM has appointed Karan Bajwa as managing director of its India business, succeeding Vanitha Narayanan. Narayanan was named

chairman of the unit, a newly-created position. Bajwa joined IBM in 2016 as executive for strategy and transformation in Asia-Pacific. He was previously managing director of Microsoft's India business.

Anil Jalali has quit IBM as executive director-HR, IBM India. He has moved to Capgemini as head-HR for India operations.

Flipkart names new CEO

Kalyan Krishnamurthy, earlier chief of category design organisation, has been elevated to the position of chief executive officer, taking over from Binny Bansal. Bansal now heads Flipkart Group organisation.

Emerson Network Power appoints new CEO

The business until now known as Emerson Network Power has announced the appointment of Rob Johnson as chief executive officer, and officially commenced a campaign to rebrand the standalone company as Vertiv.

Corning appoints Amit Bansal MD for India

Corning Inc. has appointed Amit Bansal as the company's managing director for its operations in India. Bansal will be based in Gurugram, Haryana, to spearhead the company's growth and operations while contributing to strategic planning for Corning in India.